# One Turn Is a Gnomon: the Golden Cycle Step by Step, and the Polar of the Keyed Pair





Theorem: in DICTO's twelve-station golden cycle, one whole turn is a gnomon in the classical sense of Euclid and Heron, and no shorter run of steps is; within the turn from I, its last step is the only step whose new whole is similar to an earlier station. The keyed DICTONIC pair is the golden pair minus and plus the same eight Tricaps, and the golden pair's polars are cubes with face pyramids of heights 1/φ and 1/φ², which add up to Kepler's rhombic dodecahedron

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The ideas are DICTO's: carrying the "add the next strip" structure of the gnomon method as reported for Júlia Pimentel, $n^2 + n + (n + 1) = (n + 1)^2$ [12, 13], into his three-dimensional golden cycle, and judging each step by the shape it adds as well as by its volume; the names Julias and Pimentels are DICTO's; the hull-and-remainder polar of the keyed pair, "fill them in, maybe invert, then work out the remainder" (DICTO, 24 October 2026); and, from his earlier papers, the twelve-station golden cycle, the Cleo star, the DICTONIC SOLIDS and their names. Computation, exact proofs and drafting with Claude (Anthropic).

**In short.** Take a square of 3 × 3 dots and add an L-shaped strip of 3 + 4 dots along two sides: you get the next square, 4 × 4. The strip is a gnomon: in the classical definition (Euclid, and Heron in general), the piece which, added to a figure, makes a whole of the same shape as the figure, only larger. The gnomon method as reported for Júlia Pimentel works with exactly this strip, n + (n + 1). DICTO's idea was to carry that structure into three dimensions: walk through his golden cycle of twelve nested solids, from an icosahedron out to the next icosahedron $\varphi^3$ times larger, and check at every step what it adds and whether the new whole has the shape of something before it. We built every step exactly. The answer is clean. The whole turn is a classical gnomon: the next icosahedron has the same shape as the first. No single step and no shorter run of steps is: no station has the shape of any other station, except the two icosahedra. So it is the last step, from M to the next icosahedron, that closes the gnomon. Step by step, the cycle adds spikes, pyramids, Shields and other pieces that never repeat their shapes. By volume, four steps still add a clean golden amount. DICTO's second idea concerned his keyed pair of space-filling pieces, the Lotus Jewel Axes (eight dents) and the Dodecaxes (eight keys). A dented or keyed solid has no ordinary polar, so DICTO's method is to fill the dents in (or take the keys off), take the polar of the smooth solid, and keep what was removed as the remainder. The smooth solids are the golden pair of paper #48; their polars are cubes with a low pyramid on every face, of heights $1/\varphi$ and $1/\varphi^2$, which add up to exactly 1, the height that makes Kepler's rhombic dodecahedron; and the remainder is the same eight Tricaps for both pieces. Both parts read a solid by the piece that lies between it and its neighbour.

**Theorem A (the classical gnomon of the golden cycle).** In the cycle I ⊂ Cleo star ⊂ D′ ⊂ ID ⊂ OG ⊂ rTI ⊂ TI ⊂ H ⊂ jtI ⊂ RT ⊂ M ⊂ I·$\varphi^3$ the only two similar stations are I and

I·φ³ (ratio φ³). Hence one whole turn, I·φ³ minus I, is a classical gnomon of I; no single step and no shorter run of steps is a classical gnomon; and, within the turn from I, the last step, M → I·φ³, is the only step whose new whole is similar to an earlier station. Table 3 lists what each step adds. **Corollary (volumes).** Every station is an exact multiple a + b√5 of I; Cleo star = 2·I, RT = 81·I/φ², M = φ⁸·I, I·φ³ = φ·M; exactly four steps (1, 6, 7, 11) add a rational multiple of $\varphi^k$·I.

**Theorem B (the keyed pair, hull and remainder).** The Lotus Jewel Axes and the Dodecaxes are the Icosaxes and the Unborn Axes minus and plus the same eight Tricaps, each of volume 1/(12φ²) [1]. The polar of the Icosaxes is a cube with six face pyramids of height 1/φ (in half cube edges), that of the Unborn Axes one with height 1/φ²; along the whole factor-x family of [1] the two heights are x/(1 + x) and 1/(1 + x), so they always add up to 1, the rhombic dodecahedron's height. A polar of the Lotus Jewel Axes taken face by face about one centre would put spikes over the eight dents. All results are exact (119 checks, none failed).

**Draft for DICTO.** Júlia Pimentel's method is cited from news reports [12, 13], which do not name a journal. Not published.

## 1. Where it started, and why one paper

> *Both ideas came on 24 and 25 October 2026, and both look at the piece in between: what a step of the cycle adds, and the eight small pieces that a key or a dent moves from one solid to the other.*

The golden cycle grew over three of DICTO's papers. The Spheres of Dharma [2] nest classical icosahedral solids so that the next icosahedron, φ³ times larger, closes one turn. Progenitors [3] set DICTO's Ogdoecontahedron (OG) and Hecatodihedron (H) [4] into the cycle, with the core and hull of their compound, the rectified truncated icosahedron (rTI) and its dual (jtI). Vajrayana [5] added DICTO's Cleo star and its hull D′, and closed the last loose step with the DICTO Metaxyhexecontahedron (M) [6], making twelve stations.

The gnomon is one of the oldest ideas in geometry. Euclid defines it for parallelograms, as the L-shaped piece left when a smaller similar parallelogram is taken from a corner [7, Book II, Definition 2]; Heron defines it in general as that which, added to a figure or number, makes the whole similar to the figure to which it was added (quoted in Heath's commentary on that definition [7]); growth by gnomons is the theme of D'Arcy Thompson's chapter on the equiangular spiral [8]. For squares the gnomon is the strip n + (n + 1), the structure of n² + n + (n + 1) = (n + 1)² in the method reported for Júlia Pimentel [12, 13]. DICTO proposed carrying this "add the next strip" structure into his three-dimensional cycle. A first study [S1] measured the volume each step adds; DICTO concluded that this captured "the nature of the beast" but not its shape, and a second study [S3] built every added piece exactly and tested every similarity. Part A reports both, with the classical shape test as the main statement and the volumes as a corollary.

**From the square to the solid gnomon.** We use "solid gnomon" as our descriptive term for the three-dimensional form of the classical gnomon: the shell which, added to a solid, gives a similar, larger solid (we make no claim about who first used the term). The chain is short. *Square:* n² + n + (n + 1) = (n + 1)²; the added strip n + (n + 1) is the gnomon of the square, the structure of Júlia Pimentel's method as reported [12, 13]. *Cube:* n³ + 3n² + 3n + 1 = (n +

1)³, the standard binomial identity; the added shell, three slabs n × n × 1, three rods n × 1 × 1 and one unit corner cube, is the solid gnomon of the cube. *DICTO's golden cycle:* one whole turn, the shell between I and I·φ³, is a solid gnomon of the icosahedron, with linear ratio φ³ and volume ratio (φ³)³ = φ⁹, the factor cubed (Theorem A).

The same day DICTO turned to the keyed pair of paper #48 [1], the Lotus Jewel Axes and the Dodecaxes, and theorised a polar for them by his own method: fill the dents in, take the polar, and work out the remainder. The exact study is [S2]. We report the two together because they share one theme, the piece between two forms, and because each is short. In Part A the piece is what a step adds; in Part B it is the set of eight Tricaps between a keyed piece and its smooth golden form.

## Part A. 2. The twelve stations, exactly

> *Every station is measured as a multiple of the innermost icosahedron. Ten of the twelve volumes come from the earlier papers; two, rTI and jtI, are measured here.*

The frame is that of [3]: the icosahedron I of the Spheres of Dharma has edge 1/φ and volume (5/12)(√5 − 1). The volumes of I, the Cleo star, D′, ID, OG, TI, H, RT, M and I·φ³ are sums of the exact layer volumes published in [3, 5]. For rTI and jtI the study [S1] read the corners from the stored data of [3], recovered each coordinate exactly as a + b√5 with a, b in (1/16)ℤ (error below $10^{-6}$ in every case), computed jtI's other 32 corners exactly as the poles of TI's 32 face planes in the sphere ρ² = 9/4 [3], and summed exact signed tetrahedra over the convex hull. The same procedure reproduces the published volumes of TI, H, RT and I·φ³ exactly, at the same scale, and the float hull volumes agree. Study [S3] later rebuilt all twelve stations with exact corners from the construction scripts of [3, 5], with no rounding at all, and obtained the same twelve volumes.

| Station | What it is | Volume (exact) | V / V(I), exact | ≈ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| I | icosahedron of the Spheres of Dharma [2] | −5/12 + (5/12)√5 | **1** | 1 |
| Cleo star | I with 20 Cleo-Icos as spikes [5] | −5/6 + (5/6)√5 | **2** | 2 |
| D′ | dodecahedron D at 2/3, hull of the Cleo star [5] | 10/9 + (14/27)√5 | 20/9 + (44/45)√5 | 4.4086 |
| ID | icosidodecahedron [2] | 175/48 + (79/48)√5 | 57/8 + (127/40)√5 | 14.2245 |
| OG | DICTO Ogdoecontahedron at 3φ²/4 [3] | 1975/456 + (895/456)√5 | 645/76 + (287/76)√5 | 16.9309 |
| rTI | rectified truncated icosahedron, core of the H–OG compound [3] | −15/2 + (73/8)√5 | 183/8 + (39/40)√5 | 25.0552 |
| TI | truncated icosahedron [2] | −35/4 + (39/4)√5 | 24 + (3/5)√5 | 25.3416 |
| H | DICTO Hecatodihedron [4] | −365/4 + (189/4)√5 | 87 − (132/5)√5 | 27.9678 |
| jtI | dual of rTI, hull of the H–OG compound [3] | −3465/38 + (900/19)√5 | 3321/38 − (999/38)√5 | 28.6097 |
| RT | rhombic triacontahedron [2] | −135 + (135/2)√5 | **81/φ²** = 243/2 − (81/2)√5 | 30.9392 |
| M | DICTO Metaxyhexecontahedron [5, 6] | 145/12 + (65/12)√5 | **φ⁸** = 47/2 + (21/2)√5 | 46.9787 |
| I·φ³ | the next icosahedron [2] | 235/12 + (35/4)√5 | **φ⁹** = 38 + 17√5 | 76.0132 |

**Table 1.** The twelve stations in the frame of [3] (I of edge 1/φ). Bold: the volume ratios that are a rational number times a power of φ. The volumes grow strictly in this order.

## 3. Theorem A: the classical gnomon

> *Only the two icosahedra at the ends of a turn have the same shape. So the whole turn is a gnomon in Euclid's and Heron's sense, and nothing shorter is.*

> **Theorem A (the classical gnomon of the golden cycle).** Let the twelve stations be as in Table 1, repeated in every turn at scale $\varphi^{3m}$.
> (i) Among the twelve stations exactly one pair is similar: I and I·$\varphi^3$, with linear ratio $\varphi^3 = 2 + \sqrt{5}$ (volume ratio $\varphi^9$).
> (ii) Hence the whole turn, the region between I and I·$\varphi^3$, is a classical gnomon of I, a solid gnomon: added to I it makes a whole similar to I.
> (iii) No single step, and no run of consecutive steps shorter than a whole turn, is a classical gnomon: the new whole is never similar to the station it was added to. In particular no step $k \to k + 1$ is a gnomon of station k.
> (iv) In the turn that starts at I, the last step, M → I·$\varphi^3$, is the only step whose new whole is similar to an earlier station; it is the step that closes the gnomon of the turn. The new wholes of steps 1–10 are similar to no other station of the turn.
> (v) In the endless cycle every station is similar to the same station one turn (eleven steps) earlier and to no other earlier station; so every whole turn, from whichever station it starts, is a classical gnomon of that station, and nothing shorter is.

**Proof.** Study [S3] rebuilt all twelve stations with exact corners in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$ from the construction scripts of [3, 5] (no rounding), and tested similarity exactly: two solids are similar only if their corners can be matched one to one so that every squared corner-to-corner distance scales by the same factor (mirror images allowed). Solids with different numbers of corners cannot be similar; the only stations with equal corner counts are I and I·$\varphi^3$ (12 each), and the Cleo star, RT and M (32 each). I·$\varphi^3$ = $\varphi^3$·I by construction [2]; the Cleo star, RT and M were tested pairwise and are not similar. This gives (i). A station of a later turn is a station of this turn scaled by a power of $\varphi^3$, so it is similar to the same stations; (ii)–(v) follow from (i), since a run of steps from station j to station k (j < k) is a classical gnomon exactly when station k is similar to station j. ∎

**What each step adds.** Study [S3] cut each layer exactly as in Vajrayana [5, §3]: one piece over each face of the inner station, bounded by the outer station and the cone from the centre over that face (step 1 is the 20 spikes; step 2 is DICTO's published fill of D′ [5]). All pieces of a kind are congruent, and the pieces of each step add up exactly to the layer. Table 3 lists them.

**The names.** The pieces are called Julias and Pimentels in tribute to Júlia Pimentel, whose "add the next strip" square method, as reported [12, 13], is the idea DICTO carried into three dimensions; the names are DICTO's. DICTO named the pieces of the cycle's gnomon the **Julias**, labelled G and the step number, and the 60 triangular bipyramids of the closing step the **Pimentels** (G11), in tribute to Júlia Pimentel; the spikes (G1), DICTO's fill of D′ (G2) and the Shields (G7) keep their names. The technical descriptions in brackets are working descriptions from the study [S3]. Why they differ from their classical relatives, yet fit: each piece is a cone section, the part of the shell over one face of the inner station inside the cone from the centre over that face, so its shape is forced by the two nested solids rather than by equal edges; each is therefore a distorted relative of a classical solid (for example Julia G4 of Johnson's J9 and the Pimentels of J12 [14]), and the cones over all faces divide the shell exactly.

| Step | What the step adds (pieces; all of a kind congruent) | Separate parts | Added / I |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 · I → Cleo star | **G1**: 20 Cleo-Icos (the spikes), congruent to the 20 Cleo-Icos that make up I | 20 | **1** |
| 2 · Cleo star → D′ | **G2**: DICTO's fill of D′ [5]: 12 inward pentagonal pyramids and 30 valley tetrahedra | 1 | 2/9 + (44/45)√5 |
| 3 · D′ → ID | **Julia G3** (pentagonal dome), 12 over D′'s pentagons: 15 corners, 7 pentagons and 5 triangles; nearest classical form a dodecahedral cap | 1 | 353/72 + (791/360)√5 |
| 4 · ID → OG | **Julia G4** (elongated pentagonal pyramid type), 12 over ID's pentagons: 11 corners, 1 pentagon, 5 quadrilaterals and 5 triangles; nearest Johnson J9 | 12 | 207/152 + (457/760)√5 |
| 5 · OG → rTI | **Julia G5a** (notched triangular wedge), 60 over OG's quadrilaterals: 8 corners, 5 quadrilaterals and 2 triangles; **Julia G5b** (skew hexagonal frustum), 20 over OG's hexagons: two parallel hexagons (not translates) joined by 6 quadrilaterals | 1 | 2187/152 − (2129/760)√5 |
| 6 · rTI → TI | **Julia G6** (corner tetrahedron), the 60 corners of TI, each $(1/80)\varphi^{-2}\cdot$I | 60 | **$(3/4)\varphi^{-2}$** |
| 7 · TI → H | **G7**: 20 Shields, the low hexagonal pyramids of H [4], each $(9/10)\varphi^{-4}\cdot$I | 20 | **$18\varphi^{-4}$** |
| 8 · H → jtI | **Julia G8** (pentagonal pyramid), 12 over H's pentagons; nearest Johnson J2 | 12 | 15/38 + (21/190)√5 |
| 9 · jtI → RT | **Julia G9** (skew quadrilateral pyramid), 60 over jtI's quadrilaterals, five round each five-fold corner of RT; nearest Johnson J1 | 12 | 648/19 − (270/19)√5 |
| 10 · RT → M | **Julia G10** (rhombic ridge roof), 30 over RT's rhombi: 6 corners, 1 rhombus and 6 triangles [5, §3] | 1 | −98 + 51√5 |
| 11 · M → I·$\varphi^3$ | the 60 **Pimentels, G11** (triangular bipyramids, 6 triangles), each $(1/60)\varphi^7\cdot$I [5, §3]; nearest Johnson J12; **closes the classical gnomon of the turn** | 1 | **$\varphi^7$** |

**Table 3.** What each step of one turn adds [S3]: the Julias G1–G10 and the Pimentels G11 (names DICTO's; G1, G2, G7 keep their earlier names). Nearest classical forms only; none is regular (2 to 7 edge lengths). "Separate parts": the number of connected parts of the added region (step 1: the spikes meet only along I's edges). Bold: added volumes that are a rational multiple of $\varphi^k\cdot$I (Corollary A). Step 12, the first step of the next turn, is step 1 scaled by $\varphi^3$.

**Shapes across the cycle** [S3, exact]. No piece kind of one step is similar to a piece kind of another step, except that the spike of step 1 is congruent to the Cleo-Icos that make up I (as [5] states); no piece is similar to a station; and pieces recur only as types (pyramids in steps 1, 2, 7, 8, 9; tetrahedra in steps 1, 2, 6), never as the same shape at another size. So the cycle does not grow by repeating one strip at larger and larger sizes, as the squares do; it repeats only once per turn, as a whole.

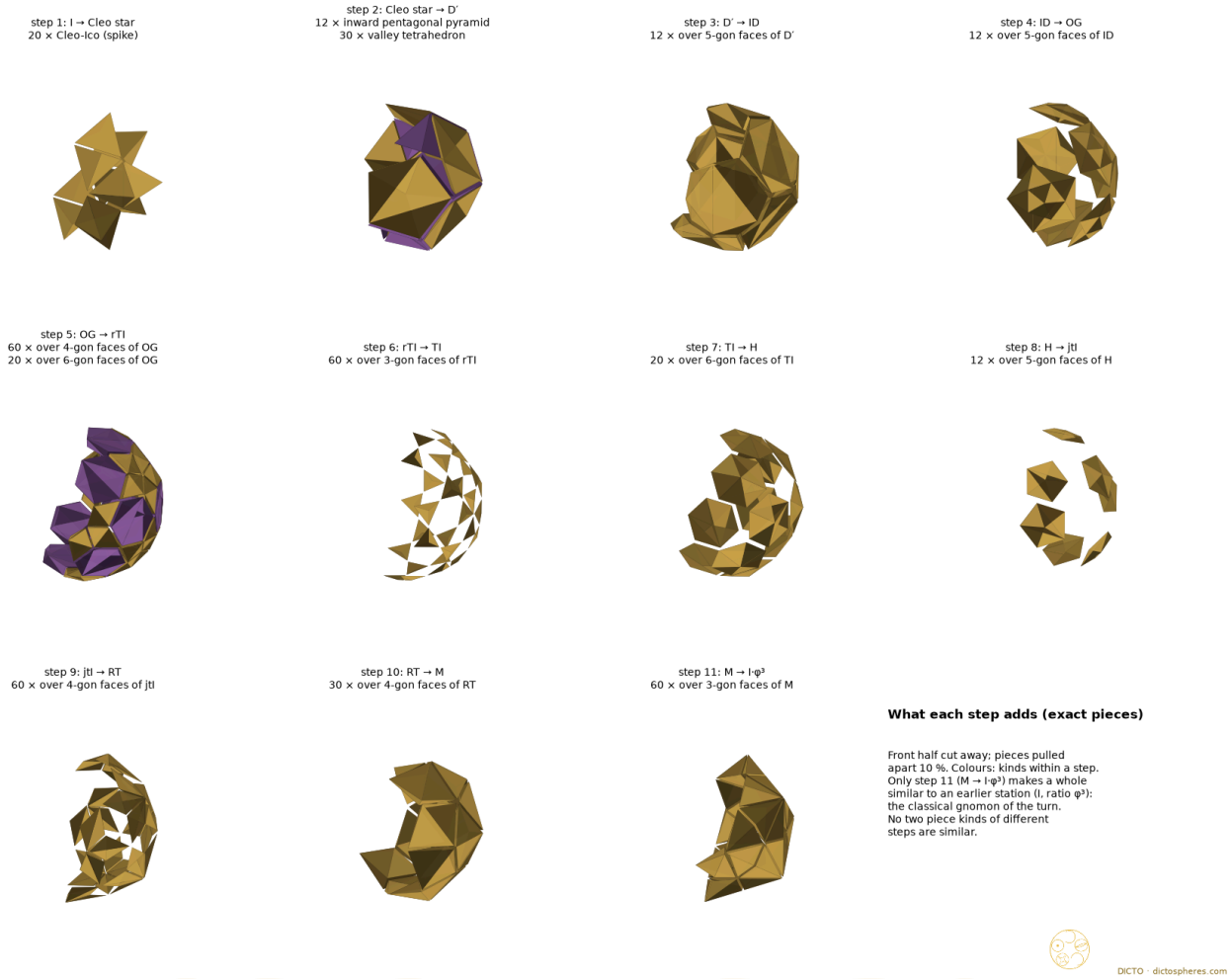



**Figure 1.** What each step adds, exactly [S3] (Table 3): the pieces G1–G11 of steps 1–11, front half cut away, pieces pulled apart by 10 %, colours by kind within a step. Only step 11 (M → I·φ³) makes a whole similar to an earlier station (I, ratio φ³): it closes the classical gnomon of the turn.

## 4. Corollary: what each step adds by volume

> *Measured by volume rather than shape, the turn opens by doubling, closes by φ, and four of its eleven steps add a clean golden amount.*

> **Corollary A (volumes).** With the volumes of Table 1:
> (i) the cycle opens by doubling: Cleo star = 2·I, the first step adds one I;
> (ii) it closes by φ: M = $\varphi^8$·I, so I·$\varphi^3$ = $\varphi^9$·I = φ·M, and the last step adds $\varphi^7$·I;
> (iii) RT = 81·I/$\varphi^2$, hence M/RT = $\varphi^{10}$/81 and I·$\varphi^3$/RT = $\varphi^{11}$/81;
> (iv) of the 66 ratios $V_j/V_i$ ($i < j$) exactly ten are of the form $q\cdot\varphi^k$ with q rational and k an integer, all among I, Cleo star, RT, M and I·$\varphi^3$;
> (v) of the eleven added volumes exactly four are of the form $q\cdot\varphi^k$·I, those of steps 1, 6, 7 and 11: I, (3/4)$\varphi^{-2}$·I, 18$\varphi^{-4}$·I and $\varphi^7$·I (Table 2). They add up to ($\varphi^9$ − 1)·I.

**Proof.** Every identity is checked by exact arithmetic in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$ [S1, C]. (i) The spikes are 20 Cleo-Icos, as many as make up I [5]. (ii) $\varphi^8 = (47 + 21\sqrt{5})/2$ = M/I; then φ·M = $\varphi^9$·I = (38 + 17√5)·I = I·$\varphi^3$, since volume scales by $(\varphi^3)^3$. (iii) RT/I · $\varphi^2$ = 81. (iv)–(v) Write x = a + b√5. Since $\varphi^k = (L_k + F_k\sqrt{5})/2$ and $\varphi^{-k} = (-1)^k(L_k - F_k\sqrt{5})/2$, with F and L the Fibonacci and Lucas numbers, x is a rational multiple of a power of φ exactly when b = 0 (k = 0) or $b/a = \pm F_k/L_k$ for some $k \geq 1$. Because $F_k$ and $L_k$ have no common factor larger than 2, only the finitely

many k with $L_k$ at most twice the denominator of b/a need testing; the test is exhaustive over all integers k. ∎

In the four golden steps every single piece is golden too: a spike is I/20, a corner tetrahedron of TI $(1/80)\varphi^{-2}\cdot I$, a Shield $(9/10)\varphi^{-4}\cdot I$, and a bipyramid of step 11 $(1/60)\varphi^{7}\cdot I$ (Table 3). The volume test and the shape test pick out different things: four steps are golden by volume, one turn is a gnomon by shape.

| Step | Added volume / I (exact) | ≈ | Form | Step ratio ≈ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| I → Cleo star | 1 | 1.0000 | **I** | 2.0000 |
| Cleo star → D′ | 2/9 + (44/45)√5 | 2.4086 | — | 2.2043 |
| D′ → ID | 353/72 + (791/360)√5 | 9.8159 | — | 3.2265 |
| ID → OG | 207/152 + (457/760)√5 | 2.7064 | — | 1.1903 |
| OG → rTI | 2187/152 − (2129/760)√5 | 8.1242 | — | 1.4798 |
| rTI → TI | 9/8 − (3/8)√5 | 0.2865 | **$(3/4)\varphi^{-2}\cdot I$** | 1.0114 |
| TI → H | 63 − 27√5 | 2.6262 | **$18\varphi^{-4}\cdot I$** | 1.1036 |
| H → jtI | 15/38 + (21/190)√5 | 0.6419 | — | 1.0230 |
| jtI → RT | 648/19 − (270/19)√5 | 2.3296 | — | 1.0814 |
| RT → M | −98 + 51√5 | 16.0395 | — | 1.5184 |
| M → $I\cdot\varphi^3$ | 29/2 + (13/2)√5 | 29.0344 | **$\varphi^{7}\cdot I$** | 1.6180 = φ |

**Table 2.** What each step adds, by volume. The ten neat ratios of Corollary A (iv): Cleo star/I = 2, RT/I = $81/\varphi^2$, M/I = $\varphi^8$, $I\cdot\varphi^3/I = \varphi^9$, RT/Cleo star = $(81/2)/\varphi^2$, M/Cleo star = $\varphi^8/2$, $I\cdot\varphi^3$/Cleo star = $\varphi^9/2$, M/RT = $\varphi^{10}/81$, $I\cdot\varphi^3$/RT = $\varphi^{11}/81$, $I\cdot\varphi^3/M = \varphi$.

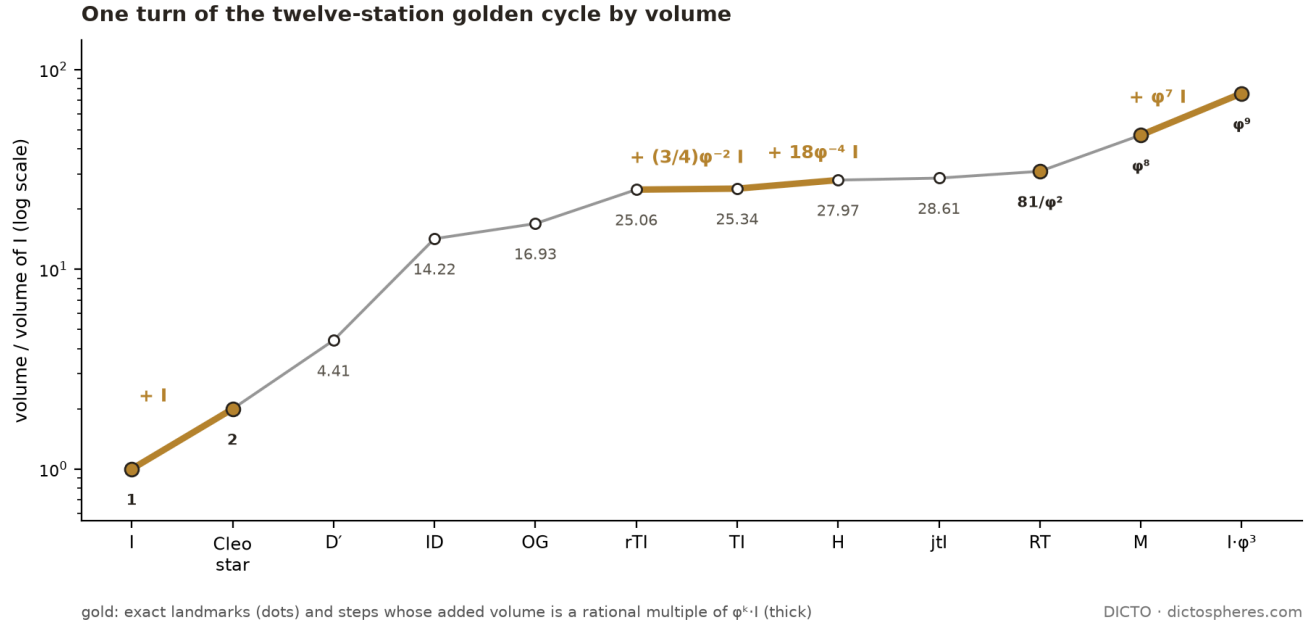



**Figure 2.** One turn of the golden cycle by volume (Table 1), each station as a multiple of I (log scale). Gold dots: stations whose volume is a rational number times a power of φ times I. Thick gold steps: the four steps that add a rational multiple of $\varphi^k\cdot I$ (Corollary A).

## Part B. 5. The keyed pair and its golden forms

> *The keyed pieces are the smooth golden pieces with eight small corners moved from one to the other. Filling the dents in, or taking the keys off, gives back the smooth pair.*

Paper #48 [1] cut the gaps of a cubic lattice of icosahedra at the golden point and obtained the golden pair, the Icosaxes (the convex hull of all permutations of (±1/2, ±φ/2, 0), at the lattice points) and the Unborn Axes (all permutations of (±1/(2φ), ±φ/2, 0), at the cube centres (φ/2)(1, 1, 1) + φℤ³), both truncated octahedra; with the factor x of [1, Theorem 4] they are T(φ) and T(1/φ) of Koca's orbit [9]. In the Lotus Jewel network the same cut gives the keyed pair: the Lotus Jewel Axes, the Icosaxes with eight Tricaps removed (dents), and the Dodecaxes, the Unborn Axes with the same eight Tricaps added (keys) [1, Theorem 3]. The study [S2] rechecks this exactly and records where each Tricap sits: its three base corners are corners of the Unborn, its apex is a corner of the cube inscribed in the Unborn's dodecahedron, its base lies in a hexagon shared by the two pieces, and the eight dents lie inside the icosahedron, pairwise apart. The Tricap has volume $(3 - \sqrt{5})/24 = 1/(12\varphi^2)$, the eight together $1 - \sqrt{5}/3 \approx 0.2546$; so $\sqrt{5} = (1 + 2\sqrt{5}/3) - 8/(12\varphi^2)$ and $2 = (1 + \sqrt{5}/3) + 8/(12\varphi^2)$, and the sum is $\varphi^3$, one lattice cell.

A solid with dents has no ordinary polar. DICTO's method reads it through its smooth form: the Icosaxes is the convex hull of the Lotus Jewel Axes, the Unborn Axes is the Dodecaxes with its keys off, and the remainder is the eight Tricaps in both cases.

## 6. Theorem B

> *Turned inside out, each golden piece becomes a cube with a low pyramid on every face. The two pyramid heights always add up to the height that makes Kepler's rhombic dodecahedron.*

> **Theorem B (hull and remainder).** Take polars in the unit sphere about each piece's own centre, and measure pyramid heights in half cube edges.
> (i) For every $x > 0$ the polar of T(x) is a cube with a square pyramid of height $x/(1 + x)$ on each face, and the polar of its partner T(1/x) one with height $1/(1 + x)$. The two heights add up to 1, the height of the pyramids that turn a cube into Kepler's rhombic dodecahedron [10].
> (ii) For the golden pair: the polar of the Icosaxes has pyramids of height $1/\varphi$ and that of the Unborn Axes of height $1/\varphi^2$, and $1/\varphi + 1/\varphi^2 = 1$. Both polars have their apexes at distance $2/\varphi$ from the centre; their cube corners lie at $2\sqrt{3}/\varphi^2$ and $2\sqrt{3}/\sqrt{5}$.
> (iii) In DICTO's hull-and-remainder reading the Lotus Jewel Axes is the polar of (ii) for the Icosaxes with the eight Tricaps as remainder, and the Dodecaxes that of the Unborn Axes with the same eight Tricaps as remainder.
> (iv) Taken face by face about the one centre, the three walls of each dent of the Lotus Jewel Axes have their poles at distance $\sqrt{(10 - 2\sqrt{5})} = 4 \sin 36° \approx 2.351$, against $2\sqrt{3}/\varphi^2 \approx 1.323$ for the hexagon the dent sits in, and ≈ 37.38° away from its direction.

**Proof.** (i) Let T be the convex hull of all permutations of (±a, ±b, 0) with $0 < a < b$. Its six squares lie in the planes $\pm x_i = b$ and its eight hexagons in $\pm x \pm y \pm z = a + b$. Their poles are $(\pm 1/b)e_i$ and the cube corners $(\pm 1, \pm 1, \pm 1)/(a + b)$, so the cube has half edge $1/(a + b)$ and the pyramid apexes stand at $1/b$; the height in half edges is $(a + b)/b - 1 = a/b$. For T(x), (a, b) = (x, 1 + x) up to scale, which gives $x/(1 + x)$; for T(1/x), (1/x, 1 + 1/x) gives $1/(1 + x)$. The sum is 1 for every x. (ii) The Icosaxes has $a/b = (1/2)/(\varphi/2) = 1/\varphi$ and the Unborn Axes $(1/(2\varphi))/(\varphi/2) = 1/\varphi^2$; the distances follow from 1/b and $\sqrt{3}/(a + b)$. (iii) is the definition of the reading together with [1, Theorem 3] as rechecked in [S2]. (iv) The dent facing the cube centre $(\varphi/2)(1, 1, 1)$ has apex $(1, 1, 1)/(2\varphi)$ and base corners (0, 1/2, φ/2), (φ/2, 0, 1/2), (1/2,

φ/2, 0), which are Icosaxes corners on the hexagon x + y + z = φ²/2; the pole n/(n·A) of each wall plane n·X = n·A has squared length 10 − 2√5, computed exactly [C]; the angle is computed from these exact vectors. ∎

**Remarks.** At Kelvin's cell, x = 1, both heights are 1/2: the polar is the tetrakis hexahedron, the classical dual of the truncated octahedron [11]; the golden pair moves the two heights apart, to 1/φ and 1/φ², without changing their sum. Part (iv) is why the reading of (iii) is used: a one-centre polar of the dented solid would carry three-pointed spikes at all eight dents, far outside the cube corners. DICTO proposed that the polar has no spikes over the dents, and the hull-and-remainder reading has none. The two golden polars do not fill space together: their edge angles, ≈ 136.35° and 153.43° for the Icosaxes' polar and ≈ 150.77° and 131.81° for the Unborn Axes' polar, allow no combination round an edge that makes 360° (float count, [S2], polarfill1.py). The study also computed the polar of one Tricap about its own centroid, a three-sided pyramid with edges in the ratio 1 : tan 72°; since that centre is a free choice, it is recorded only as a side fact.

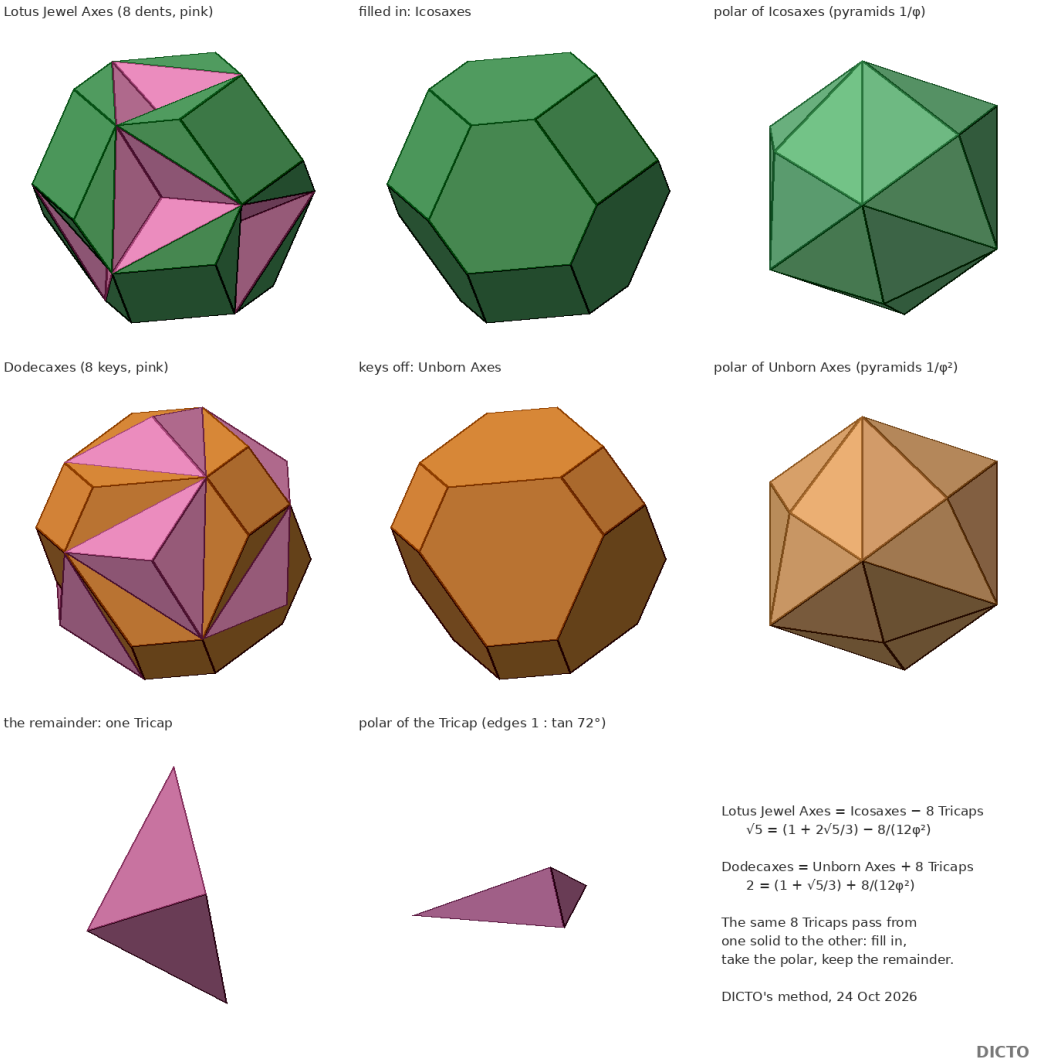



**Figure 3.** DICTO's hull-and-remainder polar [S2]. Top row: the Lotus Jewel Axes with its 8 dents (pink), filled in to the Icosaxes, and the Icosaxes' polar (pyramids 1/φ). Middle row: the Dodecaxes with its 8 keys (pink), keys off to the Unborn Axes, and its polar (pyramids 1/φ²). Bottom: the remainder, one of the eight Tricaps, and its polar about its own centroid (side fact only, see Remarks). Exact proof: keyed_polar_exact.py, 15 checks (Tricaps drawn in the orientation of [1]).

## 7. Conclusion

> *Read by shape, one turn of the golden cycle is a classical gnomon and nothing shorter is; read by volume, it opens by doubling and closes by φ. The keyed pair shows one remainder shared by two pieces whose polars complement each other.*

Carried into three dimensions, as was DICTO's idea, the "add the next strip" structure of the square gnomon meets the golden cycle in one place: the whole turn. The next icosahedron has the shape of the first, and no other station has the shape of any other, so the last step, M → I·$\varphi^3$, is the one that closes the classical gnomon. On the way the cycle adds spikes, DICTO's fill of D′, Shields, and the Julias and Pimentels that DICTO named for Júlia Pimentel, and no piece shape repeats at another size. By volume the turn opens by doubling and closes by φ, RT sits at 81/$\varphi^2$ and M at $\varphi^8$, and four steps add a golden multiple of the icosahedron. DICTO's hull-and-remainder polar reads the keyed pair through the golden pair: the polars are cubes with pyramids of heights 1/φ and 1/$\varphi^2$, which add up to Kepler's rhombic dodecahedron, as every pair of the factor-x family does, and the eight Tricaps are the common remainder. Open points: whether another choice of stations makes a shorter run of steps a classical gnomon; and whether pyramid-capped cubes with heights adding to 1 can fill space together at other sizes or with the Tricaps as separate pieces.

## 8. What is known, and what is not found

> *The gnomon, the solids and polar duality are classical. What we did not find is this reading of DICTO's cycle and pair.*

**Known.** The gnomon and its classical definitions [7], growth by gnomons [8], and the square gnomon n + (n + 1) as in the method reported for Júlia Pimentel [12, 13]; the volumes of I, ID, TI and RT, and the rectified truncated icosahedron and its dual as solids (noted in [3]); the stations and their volumes of I, Cleo star, D′, ID, OG, TI, H, RT, M and I·$\varphi^3$ [2–6], Cleo star = 2·I, the spike as a Cleo-Ico, DICTO's fill of D′ and the pieces of steps 10 and 11 [5]; the Shields [4]; polar reciprocity of convex polyhedra and the tetrakis hexahedron as the dual of the truncated octahedron [11]; the rhombic dodecahedron as a cube with six pyramids of height half its edge [10]; the T(x) orbit [9]; the Johnson solids J1, J2, J9, J12 [14]; the golden and keyed pairs, the Tricap and its volume [1].
**Not found**, in the sources searched (below): the classical gnomon test of this cycle (only the whole turn); the exact pieces of steps 3–9 and the similarity tests between all pieces and stations; the exact volumes of rTI and jtI as stations of this cycle; M = $\varphi^8$·I and RT = 81·I/$\varphi^2$; the four golden volume steps; the polar heights 1/φ and 1/$\varphi^2$ of the golden pair and the sum-to-one along the factor-x family. Part B (i) is elementary and may well be known in some form; "not found" is limited to these sources and is not a claim of novelty.
**Sources searched, 25 October 2026.** DICTO's reference library (ask-library, eight queries: gnomon and figurate numbers; golden volume ratios of nested icosahedral solids; truncated octahedron and tetrakis hexahedron as polars; polar reciprocation; rectified truncated icosahedron volume; polars of non-convex solids; Euclid Book II and Heath; Aristotle on the gnomon), which holds Heath's Euclid volume III but not volume I, and no gnomon or polar-height source; DICTO's own papers [1–6] and Collected Geometric Works, Version 24; Crossref for every DOI below. Heron's definition is cited as quoted in Heath's commentary [7], not read here; the news reports [12, 13] are cited as recorded in study [S3]. No web search was made for this draft.

## References


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[S1] Study "Gnomon rule, golden cycle", studies/2026-10-24-gnomon-cycle (gnomon_exact.py, gnomon_table.py, gnomon_all12.py; commits afd8a42, 4b05e6f, 4cac277).
[S2] Study "Shadow forms", studies/2026-10-23-shadow-forms/polar (keyed_polar_exact.py, keyed_polar1.py, keyed_polar2.py, polarfill1.py; commits 4c18a0b, e9aed63).
[S3] Study "Gnomon shapes", studies/2026-10-25-gnomon-shapes (dump_stations.py, gnomon_shapes.py, qs.py, fig_steps.py; gnomon-shapes.txt, pieces.json; commits 81d1463, ecffa9a).
[C] This paper's own check script, papers/2026-10-25-gnomon-polar/checks.py → checks.txt.


## Appendix. Checks

| Script | What it checks | PASS | FAIL |
|---|---|---|---|
| gnomon_shapes.py [S3] | exact stations (all stored points corners), all twelve volumes = Table 1, every nesting, every step's pieces sum to the layer, all pieces of a kind congruent, DICTO's fill of D′, spike = core Cleo-Ico, I·φ³ ~ I the only similar pair of stations | 63 | 0 |
| gnomon_exact.py [S1] | star = 2I, I·φ³ = φ·M, M = φ⁸I, I·φ³ = φ⁹I | 4 | 0 |
| gnomon_all12.py [S1] | method reproduces TI, H, RT, I·φ³; rTI and jtI exact vs float hulls; jtI = hull(TI ∪ PD), 32 poles; strict growth | 9 | 0 |
| gnomon_table.py [S1] | layer sums of [3] reproduce RT (assertion) | 1 | 0 |
| keyed_polar_exact.py [S2] | Tricap volume and position, dents and keys, √5 and 2, polar heights 1/φ and 1/φ², tan 72° | 15 | 0 |
| checks.py [C] | Tables 1–2, the exhaustive φ-power test, the square and cube identities, Theorem B (i)–(iv) symbolically | 27 | 0 |
| **total (exact)** | | **119** | **0** |

All scripts re-run on dicto-big-brother on 25 October 2026 with output identical to the saved files (the saved gnomon-table.txt carries one extra line, RT/I·φ² = 81, which is check RT = 81·I/φ² of [C]). Exact arithmetic: Python fractions over ℚ(√5) and sympy; in [S3] floats only propose candidate hull faces and corner matchings, which are then decided exactly; floats also for the angles of Theorem B (iv) and the Remarks, and the figures.